PARMAR RAILWAY

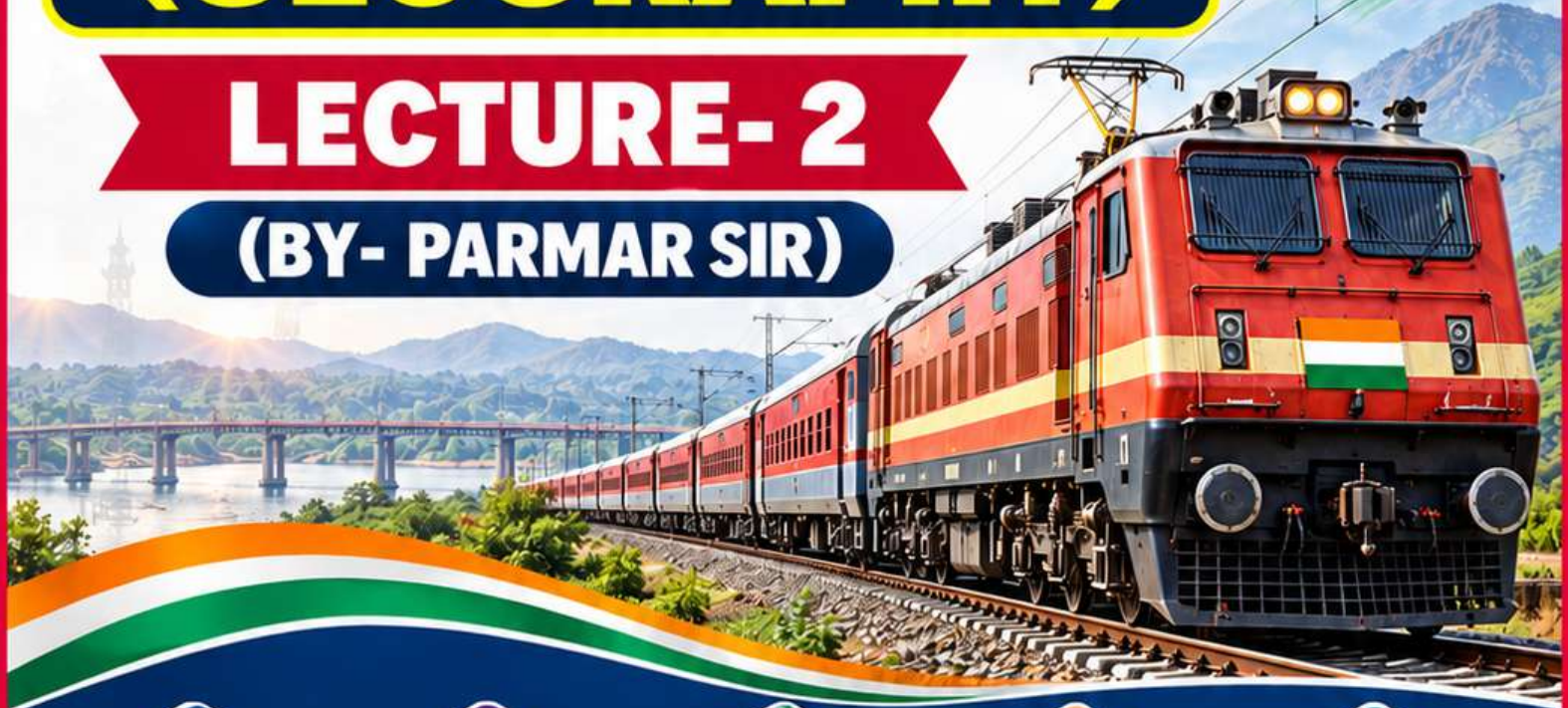
COMPLETE GK PYQ BATCH

GENERAL KNOWLEDGE

(GEOGRAPHY)

LECTURE- 2

(BY- PARMAR SIR)

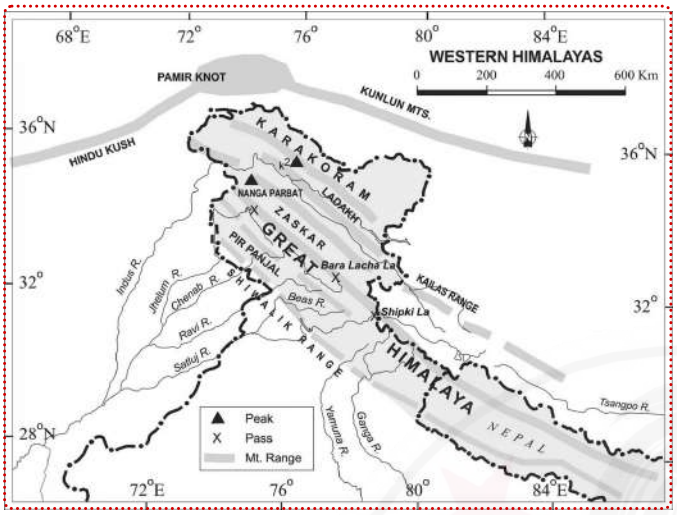


PHYSICAL GEOGRAPHY | INDIA GEOGRAPHY | WORLD GEOGRAPHY | ENVIRONMENT GEOGRAPHY | MAPPING CONCEPTS

Q1. The Atal Tunnel is built in which Himalayan range?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26, 15 Jun 2026, 4:30 PM - 6:00 PM)

A. Karakoram Range
B. Pir Panjal Range
C. Zaskar Range
D. Dhauladhar Range



- **Atal Tunnel**
  - Location: **Himachal Pradesh**
  - Length: **9.02 km**
  - Connects **Manali** with the **Lahaul-Spiti Valley**
  - Built because the **Rohtang Pass** route (same two places) is longer
- **Pir Panjal** = local name of the **Lesser (Middle) Himalaya** in **Kashmir** and part of **Himachal**
- Elimination
  - **Karakoram** is far north, even above Ladakh
  - **Zaskar** is also far north (Trans Himalaya)
  - So the tunnel near Manali can only be in **Pir Panjal**

REVISION OF LECTURE 06

- India has **6 physiographic divisions**
  - Himalayas (northern mountains)
  - Northern Plains
  - Thar Desert
  - Peninsular Plateau (the **largest** division)
  - Coastal Plains
  - Group of Islands (Lakshadweep and Andaman and Nicobar)
- Thar Desert
  - Most densely populated desert in the world
  - Lies to the north-west of the Aravalli
- Latitudes
  - Total latitudes = 181 (0 to 90 degrees in both hemispheres)
  - Latitudinal circles = 179
  - Reason: the two poles are points, not circles (181 - 2)

HIMALAYAN BASICS

- **Himalayas** = a chain of mountain ranges (parvat shrinkhala), not one mountain
  - **Peak** = one high top
- **Mountain range** = a series of mountains with many peaks
- It is not one series but **many parallel series**
  - North to south: **Trans Himalaya > Great Himalaya > Lesser Himalaya > Shiwalik**
- Other names
  - Great Himalaya = **Inner Himalaya**
  - Lesser Himalaya = **Middle Himalaya**
  - Shiwalik = Outer **Himalaya**
- Average height
  - Great Himalaya: **6000 m** (highest peaks are here)
  - Lesser Himalaya: **4000 m**

Q2. Which Himalayan region has greater altitudinal variations?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26, 16 Mar 2026, Shift 3)

A. Southern Himalayan region
B. Northern Himalayan region
C. Western Himalayan region
D. Eastern Himalayan region

- **Altitudinal variation** = height changes suddenly: very low peaks and very high peaks lie close together
- This is seen most in the **Eastern Himalaya**
  - Example: Sikkim has **Kanchenjunga**
- The **Shiwalik is absent** in the north-east

ORIENTATION (DIRECTION) OF THE HIMALAYAS

- **Western Himalaya** (Jammu and Kashmir side): **north-west to south-east**
- **Sikkim and Darjeeling (West Bengal)**: roughly **east-west**
- **Arunachal Pradesh** (Eastern Himalaya): **southwest to northeast**
- Eastern Himalayas are also called **Purvanchal**

Q3. Which glacier, located in the Karakoram range, is the longest in this range and the second longest in the world outside the polar regions?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26, 24 Mar 2026, Shift 2)

A. Baltoro Glacier
B. Gangotri Glacier
C. Pindari Glacier
D. Siachen Glacier

- **Siachen** is the longest glacier of the **Karakoram**
- It is the **2nd longest non-polar glacier** in the world
- Longest in the world: **Lambert Glacier (Antarctica)**
- Longest non-polar glacier: **Fedchenko Glacier (Tajikistan)**
- **Polar regions** = Arctic (90 degrees N) and

KARAKORAM GLACIERS

- **Baltoro, Hispar, Biafo, Siachen**
- **Operation Meghdoot** was run by the Indian Army at Siachen
- Siachen = **highest battlefield in the world**

TRANS HIMALAYA

- Made of **3 ranges**, from north to south: **Karakoram > Ladakh > Zaskar**
  - Tip: close your eyes and picture Karakoram on top, then Ladakh, then Zaskar
- In the Tibet area the range continues as the **Kailash Range**
- **Pamir Knot**: knot-like junction of **Hindu Kush, Kunlun** and other ranges, near Afghanistan and Pakistan
  - **Hindu Kush** and **Kunlun** are not in India
  - Pamir Knot is called the **Roof of the World**
  - **Tibet Plateau** is also called the Roof of the World
  - Exam tip: both will not come together in the options
- Trans Himalaya has a **different cause of origin** from Great, Lesser and Shiwalik (no depth needed)

Q4. Which of the following is the highest Himalayan peak located in India (excluding POK)?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 04 Sept 2025, Shift 2)

A. Dhaulagiri
B. Kanchenjunga
C. Mount Everest
D. Nanga Parbat

- **Kanchenjunga**
  - Location: **Sikkim**
  - Height: **8598 m**
  - Third highest peak in the world
- **K2** would be the answer if "excluding PoK" were not written (K2 lies in the PoK area)
- **Mount Everest** is on the **Nepal-Tibet border**, **Dhaulagiri** is in **Nepal**
- **Sikkim Himalaya**: highest peak is **Kanchenjunga**

HIGHEST PEAKS OF THE WORLD

- 1st: **Mount Everest, 8848 m**
- 2nd: **K2** (also called **Godwin Austen**), **8611 m**
  - Lies in the **PoK** area
  - Located in the **Karakoram** (Trans Himalaya), **not** in the Great Himalaya
- 3rd: **Kanchenjunga, 8598 m**
- 4th: **Mount Lhotse**, about **8516 m**, Tibet region

GREAT HIMALAYA PEAKS (average height 6000 m)
- Mount Everest, Kanchenjunga, Lhotse
- **Makalu, Dhaulagiri, Annapurna**: all in **Nepal**

UTTARAKHAND
- **Nanda Devi**
  - Highest peak of **Uttarakhand**
  - Height **7816 m**
  - In the Great Himalaya, in India
- **Mount Kamet** is also in Uttarakhand (second highest of the state)

Q5. The Himalayan Mountain ranges stretch in a west-east direction from the Indus River to which major Indian river?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 28 Aug 2025, Shift 3)

A. Godavari
B. Brahmaputra
C. Ganga
D. Yamuna

- Himalayas run **west to east**
  - **West end: Indus River**
  - **East end: Brahmaputra** (called **Dihang** in Arunachal Pradesh)
- Source and course of the rivers will be studied in the river system lecture

REGIONAL DIVISION OF THE HIMALAYAS (ON THE BASIS OF RIVERS)
- **Punjab Himalaya**: Indus to **Sutlej**
- **Kumaon Himalaya**: Sutlej to **Kali** (Garhwal-Kumaon, Uttarakhand)
- **Nepal Himalaya**: Kali to **Tista**
- **Assam Himalaya**: **Tista** to **Brahmaputra (Dihang)**

HIMALAYAN PASSES
- Exam tip: know which pass connects which places
- **Fotu La**: on the **Zaskar** range
- **Mig La**
  - **Highest motorable pass** in the world (this has changed; earlier it was **Umling La**)
  - Location: **eastern Ladakh**
  - Height: about **5913 m**

- **Uttarakhand: Niti, Mana, Mulingla, Mansa Dhura, Lipulekh, Limpiyadhura**
- **Arunachal Pradesh**: Bum La, Bomdi La, Yongyap, Dihang Pass, Diphu
  - **Diphu** is at the **tri-junction**
- **Sikkim: Nathu La, Jelep La**
- **Himachal Pradesh**
  - **Shipki La**: the Sutlej enters India through it
  - **Rohtang Pass**: Manali to Lahaul-Spiti Valley (the link now served by the Atal Tunnel)
  - **Bara Lacha La**: Lahaul-Spiti Valley to **Leh**
  - Route: Manali > Lahaul-Spiti (Rohtang / Atal Tunnel) > Leh (Bara Lacha La)

- **Jammu and Kashmir, Ladakh**
  - **Banihal** and **Pir Panjal** passes: connect **Jammu** with **Kashmir**
  - **Burzil Pass**: Kashmir to **Gilgit-Baltistan**
  - **Zoji La**: Kashmir to **Leh**
  - Pensi La: used to come down from Leh towards the J&K side; memory tip: use the "pencil" to come down
  - **Mintaka** and **Aghil** passes: in the **Karakoram** area of Ladakh

Q6. Which of the following mountain ranges contains the 'Valley of Flowers' National Park?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 21 Jun 2025, Shift 3)

A. West Himalaya
B. Dhauladhar
C. Pir Panjal
D. Karakoram

- **Valley of Flowers National Park is in Uttarakhand**
- Other options do not fit the location
  - **Pir Panjal**: Kashmir and part of Himachal
  - **Dhauladhar**: Himachal
  - **Karakoram**: far north (Trans Himalaya)
- So the answer is the general term **West Himalaya**

LOCAL NAMES OF THE LESSER (MIDDLE) HIMALAYA
- **Pir Panjal**: Kashmir and part of Himachal
- **Dhauladhar**: Himachal
- **Nag Tibba**: Uttarakhand
- **Mahabharat Range**: Nepal
- **PEAK vs RANGE (common confusion)**
- **Dhaulagiri** = a **peak** in **Nepal** (Great Himalaya); also called **White Mountain** (Shwet Parvat)
- **Dhauladhar** = a **range** (local name of the Middle Himalaya in Himachal), not a peak

UTTARAKHAND
- **Bugyals** = summer grasslands (grishmakaleen ghas bhumi)
- **Bhotia** = tribe found here

KASHMIR HIMALAYA
- **Karewa**
  - Soft, unconsolidated **lacustrine (lake) deposits**
  - Considered very good for **saffron** cultivation

Q7. The longitudinal valleys between the lesser Himalayas and the Shiwaliks are called:

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 19 Jun 2025, Shift 1)

A. Doabs
B. Meanders
C. Khadars
D. Duns

- **Duns** = **longitudinal valleys** between the **Lesser (Middle) Himalaya** and the **Shiwalik**
- Examples: **Dehradun, Kotli Dun, Patli Dun**
- Largest Dun: **Dehradun**

OTHER OPTIONS
- **Doab** = area between **two rivers**
  - Example: **Raichur Doab** between **Krishna** and **Tungabhadra** (Vijayanagara and Bahmani kingdoms in History)
- **Meander** = winding bend of a river
- **Khadar** = new alluvium

DUARS (DWARS)
- **Shiwalik is absent** in the **north-east**
- **Duars** take its place
  - **Dwar** = gate; the area outside a gate is called dwar
  - Material deposited by rivers
  - Good for **tea cultivation**; famous for **tea gardens**

Q8. What natural feature existed between the Himalayas and the Deccan Plateau before the formation of the Great Plain?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 18 Jun 2025, Shift 1)

A. A deep ocean trench
B. A mountain range
C. A dense forest
D. A shallow trough or geosyncline

- **Geosyncline** = a large depression (like a pit)
- This depression was the **Tethys Sea**
- The Himalayas and the Northern Plains formed in the place of the **Tethys Sea**

FORMATION OF THE HIMALAYAS
- All land was once together as one landmass: **Pangaea**
- All water was together as one ocean: **Panthalassa**
- Pangaea broke into two parts
  - Northern part: **Laurasia**
  - Southern part: **Gondwanaland**
- **India** was part of **Gondwanaland**
  - It was once in the **Southern Hemisphere**
  - The **Indian Plate** broke away and **drifted north**
- The Indian Plate **collided** with the **Eurasian Plate**
- The **Tethys Sea** region became a **series of mountains**
- It was **not one collision**: many collisions happened one after another
  - So we see **multiple series** of mountains (Trans, Great, Lesser, Shiwalik)

Q9. The easternmost extension of the Himalayas does NOT include which of the following?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 17 Jun 2025, Shift 1)

A. Naga Hills
B. Patkai Hills
C. Khasi Hills
D. Mizo Hills

- **Not part of it (part of the Peninsular Plateau)**
  - **Garo, Khasi, Jaintia** (Meghalaya)
  - **Mikir, Rengma**
- Reason: their **cause of origin is different**
  - Himalayas: formed when the **Indian and Eurasian plates collided**; young fold mountains (navin valit parvat)
  - Peninsular Plateau hills: very old

- Easternmost extension of the Himalayas = **Purvanchal Hills** (Arunachal side)
  - **Dafla, Miri, Abor, Mishmi, Nishi** hills (Arunachal Pradesh)
  - **Patkai Bum**
  - **Naga Hills**
  - **Manipur Hills**
  - **Mizo Hills** (also called Lushai Hills)
  - **Barail Range**

Q10. Which mountain range in India is one of the oldest fold mountains in the world?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26, 15 Jun 2026, 12:45 PM - 2:15 PM)

A. Eastern Ghats
B. Himalayas
C. Karakoram Range
D. Aravalli Range

- **Peninsular Plateau** age: about **300-400 million years** (30-40 crore)

- **Aravalli**: about **500 million years** old (50 crore)
- **Himalayas**: about **50 million years** old (5 crore); Aravalli is about **10 times older**
- Aravalli = **old fold mountains**
- Himalayas = **young fold mountains**
- Aravalli is treated as part of the **Peninsular Plateau**

Q11. The Western Ghats are highest in which region?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26, 13 Jun 2026, 4:30 PM - 6:00 PM)

A. Tamil Nadu
B. Goa
C. Kerala
D. Karnataka

- Western Ghats pass through **6 states: Gujarat > Maharashtra > Goa > Karnataka > Kerala > Tamil Nadu**
- Three ranges to remember: **Nilgiri, Anamalai, Cardamom**

- **Western Ghats = western boundary** of the Peninsular Plateau; **Eastern Ghats** = eastern boundary
- Highest peak of the Western Ghats: **Anaimudi, 2695 m**
  - Also the highest peak of **South India**
  - Located in the **Anamalai Range, Kerala**
- So the Ghats are highest in **Kerala**
- Second highest peak of the Western Ghats: **Doddabetta**
  - In the **Nilgiri** range, **Tamil Nadu**

Q12. Which of the following is located in the northern part of the Eastern Ghats?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 09 Sept 2025, Shift 2)

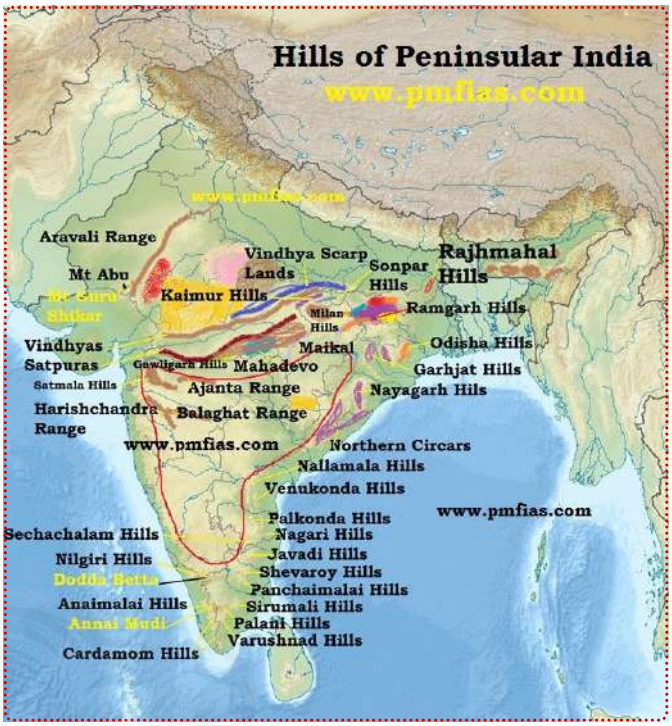
A. Mahendragiri hills
B. Nilgiri hills
C. Doddabetta hills
D. Anaimalai hills

- **Mahendragiri**
  - Location: **Odisha**
  - Height: **1501 m**
  - Considered the **highest peak of the Eastern Ghats**
- The other options belong to the **Western Ghats**
  - Nilgiri (contains Doddabetta) and Anaimalai

- Some sources give **Jindhagada** or **Arma Konda (Andhra Pradesh)** as the highest, with **1680–1690 m**

EASTERN GHATS HILLS (north to south)

- **Nallamala, Venukonda, Palkonda, Nagari, Javadi, Shevaroy, Panchamalai, Sirumalai, Palani, Varushnad**
- Memory tip: **"Nalla Venu Palko na ja saka, to paanch sir pal liye"**
  - Gives the north-to-south order and all the hills together
  - The order is not asked in exams; the tip is for memory only
- **Seshachalam Hills**
  - Part of the Eastern Ghats, **Andhra Pradesh**
  - **Tirupati Balaji Temple** is located here



Q13. What type of rocks mainly compose the Peninsular Plateau of India?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 09 Sept 2025, Shift 3)

A. Recent volcanic lava deposits from plate margins
B. Layers of limestone and sandstone from marine origin
C. Old crystalline, igneous and metamorphic rocks
D. Young sedimentary rocks formed in coastal plains

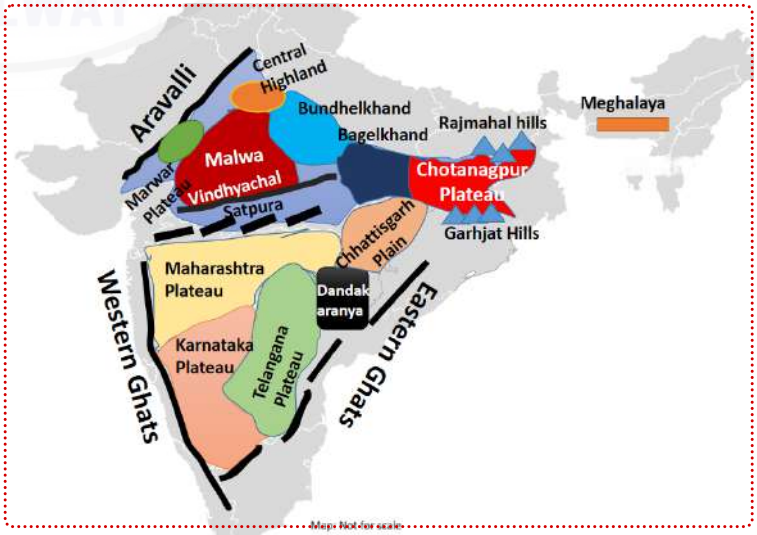
- The Peninsular Plateau is **very old**, so its rocks are **old crystalline, igneous and metamorphic**
- It is **not young**: young formations belong to the Himalayas

- **Volcanic (lava) deposits** are seen only in the **north-western part** of the plateau
  - This is where **black soil** is found (covered in detail in the Soil topic)

Q14. Which plateau is NOT a part of the Patland series?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 09 Sept 2025, Shift 1)

A. Ranchi Plateau
B. Deccan Plateau
C. Malwa Plateau
D. Hazaribagh Plateau



- The **Narmada River** divides the Peninsular Plateau into two parts
  - **North of Narmada: Central Highlands** (Kendriya Uchch Bhumi)
  - **South of Narmada: Deccan Plateau** (shape of an **inverted triangle**)
- **Patland series** = Flat-topped plateaus of the Chotanagpur region (Ranchi, Hazaribagh, Palamu).
- **Central Highlands plateaus** = Marwar (Mewar), Malwa, Bundelkhand, Baghelkhand (separate regions).
- The **Deccan Plateau** is the lower part and is not in this series

PLATEAU

- Plateau = land raised above the surrounding plain with a **flat top**; has no peaks like a mountain
- Average height of a plateau: **500–600 m**

DECCAN PLATEAU
- Made up of **Maharashtra, Karnataka, Telangana** and **Dandakaranya** plateaus
- No need to memorise these; remember **Central Highlands** (upper part) and **Deccan Plateau** (lower part)

CHOTANAGPUR PLATEAU
- Its own smaller plateaus: **Ranchi Plateau, Hazaribagh Plateau**

Q15. Why is the peninsular plateau considered geologically stable?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 08 Sept 2025, Shift 2)

A. It is located on an ancient shield region with low seismic activity.
B. It is located in a zone of frequent plate collisions.
C. It is part of a young fold mountain system with active faults.
D. It was formed by recent volcanic eruptions and earthquakes.

- The plateau sits on an **ancient shield region**
- There is **no plate boundary** and **no plate collision** here, so seismic activity is **low**
- No **active fault** in general

HIMALAYAS FOR COMPARISON
- The **Indian Plate** and **Eurasian Plate** meet in the Himalayan region (plate boundary)
- So the Himalayan region is a **high-danger earthquake zone**
  - Falls in a high **seismic zone** (IV and V; teacher said "Zone 3 and 4")

NITTO
- Options B, C and D all describe an unstable, active region (they say the same thing)
- Option A is the odd one out, which is why it is the answer

Q16. Which fault in the Peninsular Plateau is known for recurrent seismic activity?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 02 Sept 2025, Shift 1)

A. Vindhya Fault
B. Malda Fault
C. Bhima Fault
D. Narmada Fault

- The plateau is mostly stable, but some parts are active
  - **Bhuj (Gujarat)** earthquake of **2001**: a very strong earthquake
  - Gujarat's Bhuj area is quite seismically active

- **Bhima Fault** is known for seismic activity in the Peninsular Plateau
- Location: **Maharashtra-Karnataka border**
- The area is slightly **seismically active**)

Q17. Which range is known for its rich biodiversity and is a UNESCO World Heritage Site?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 08 Aug 2025, Shift 3)

A. Satpura Range
B. Western Ghats
C. Eastern Ghats
D. Chotanagpur plateau

- **Western Ghats (Sahyadri)** are famous for biodiversity (jaiv vividhta)
- Declared a **UNESCO World Heritage Site** in **2012**

- **IMPORTANT DAYS**
- **22 March:** World Water Day
- **22 April:** Earth Day
- **22 May:** Biodiversity Day

Q18. Which of the following statements about the Peninsular Plateau of India is NOT correct?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 08 Aug 2025, Shift 1)

A. Western Ghats are higher than Eastern Ghats.
B. Deccan Plateau is a triangular landmass south of Narmada.
C. Peninsular plateau consists of Northern, Central Highlands & Deccan.
D. Composed of old crystalline, igneous and metamorphic rocks.

WESTERN GHATS vs EASTERN GHATS

- **Western Ghats** are higher than the Eastern Ghats
- Height of the Western Ghats **increases from north to south**
- **Western Ghats are continuous; Eastern Ghats are discontinuous** (cut in many places)
  - Reason: the plateau is **tilted towards the east**, so most rivers flow east and cut through the Eastern Ghats

- **A is correct**: Western Ghats are higher
  - Average height of **Western Ghats: 1200 m**
  - Average height of **Eastern Ghats: 600 m** (just half)
- **B is correct**: Deccan Plateau is an **inverted triangle** south of the Narmada
- **C is wrong**: the plateau has **Central Highlands** and **Deccan Plateau**; there is no "Northern" division in what was taught
- **D is correct**: old rocks; the Himalayas are the young ones

Q19. Which of the following physiographic regions lies north of the Narmada River?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 24 Jun 2025, Shift 1)

A. Deccan Plateau
B. Karnataka Plateau
C. Telangana Plateau
D. Malwa Plateau

- **South of Narmada**: Deccan Plateau (inverted triangle) with the Karnataka and Telangana plateaus
- **North of Narmada**: Central Highlands, which include the **Malwa Plateau**
- Other Central Highlands plateaus: **Mewar, Bundelkhand, Baghelkhand, Chotanagpur**

Q20. Which hill station is located in the Nilgiri Hills?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 23 Jun 2025, Shift 2)

A. Ooty
B. Darjeeling
C. Shimla
D. Mussoorie

- **Ooty** lies in the **Nilgiri Hills**
- The **Nilgiri Hills** are where the **Western Ghats meet the Eastern Ghats**

PEAKS

- **Doddabetta: Nilgiri Hills** (second highest peak of the Western Ghats and South India)
- **Anaimudi: Anamalai Hills** (highest peak)
- **Palakkad (Palghat) Gap**, also called **Palghat Pass**: the gap/pass between the Nilgiri and Anamalai hills

GHATS (PASSES) OF MAHARASHTRA

- **Bhor Ghat: Mumbai to Pune**
  - Memory tip: "bhor" = early morning; people go to work early; **Pune** is the **IT industry** hub
- **Thal Ghat: Mumbai to Nashik**

Q21. The Shillong Plateau is divided into several parts. Which of the following is not a part of it?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 18 Jun 2025, Shift 2)

A. Mikir Hills
B. Khasi Hills
C. Maikala Range
D. Garo Hills

- **Shillong Plateau = Meghalaya Plateau**
- Parts: **Garo, Khasi, Jaintia hills; Mikir Hills** are also counted
- **Maikal Range** is in central India, far from Meghalaya

- **Karbi Anglong Plateau = Mikir** and **Rengma** hills (Assam)

HIGHEST PEAKS OF NORTH-EASTERN STATES

- **Mizoram: Phawngpui** (also called Blue Mountain)
- **Tripura: Betling Shib**
- **Meghalaya: Shillong Peak**
- **Arunachal Pradesh: Kangto**

Q22. Which of the following is the highest peak of the Maikal range?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 19 Jun 2025, Shift 1)

A. Kalsubai
B. Amarkantak
C. Guru Shikhar
D. Anamudi

- **Maikal** lies where the **Vindhya** and **Satpura** meet (junction point)
  - Usually counted as a part of Satpura
- Highest peak of Maikal: **Amarkantak**

- **Kalsubai:** highest peak of **Maharashtra**
- **Guru Shikhar**
  - Height **1722 m**
  - In the **Mount Abu Hills**
  - Highest peak of the **Aravalli**
- **Anamudi: 2695 m;** tops all of **South India**

Q23. Which of the following is NOT a part of the Peninsular Plateau's major divisions?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 16 Jun 2025, Shift 2)

A. Central Highlands
B. Purvanchal Hills
C. Deccan Plateau
D. Northeastern Plateau

- Major divisions of the Peninsular Plateau
  - **Central Highlands** (north of Narmada)
  - **Deccan Plateau** (inverted triangle, south of Narmada)
  - **North-Eastern Plateau** (**Meghalaya Plateau** and **Karbi Anglong Plateau**)
- **Purvanchal Hills** (Dafla, Miri, Abor, Mishmi, Nishi, Patkai Bum, Barail Range, Manipur Hills, Mizo Hills) are part of the **Himalayas**, not the plateau

Q24. Anaimudi, the highest peak in South India, is located at the tri-junction of which three hill ranges?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 12 Jun 2025, Shift 1)

A. Nilgiri Hills, Western Ghats, Eastern Ghats
B. Rajmahal Hills, Garo Hills, Khasi Hills
C. Annamalai Range, Cardamom Hills, Palani Hills
D. Mahadeo Hills, Maikala Range, Rajpipla Hills

- **Anaimudi** lies in the **Anamalai Range**, so the option containing **Anamalai** is correct
- Do not miss Anamalai in any option

SATPURA SEQUENCE (east to west)
- **Maikal (Amarkantak) > Mahadeo > Asirgarh > Rajpipla**
- **Maikal:** junction point of Satpura and Vindhya
- **Mahadeo Hills: Dhupgarh,** highest peak of Satpura
- **Asirgarh:** known for the **Asirgarh Fort**

Q25. What is the region lying to the north of the Narmada River called?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 12 Jun 2025, Shift 2)

A. Deccan Plateau
B. Chota Nagpur Plateau
C. Central Highlands
D. Eastern Ghats

- **North of Narmada: Central Highlands** (Kendriya Uchch Bhumi)
- **South of Narmada: Deccan Plateau**
- Plateaus of the Central Highlands: **Marwar (Mewar), Malwa, Bundelkhand, Baghelkhand, Chotanagpur**
- **Chotanagpur** is one plateau inside the Central Highlands, not the name of the whole region

Q26. Which of the following is the highest point of the Satpura Range?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 10 Jun 2025, Shift 3)

A. Dhupgarh
B. Mount Abu
C. Parasnath
D. Anai Mudi

- Dhupgarh
  - Highest peak of **Satpura**
  - In the **Mahadeo Hills**
  - Height **1350–1352 m**
- Other options belong to other regions
  - **Mount Abu (Guru Shikhar): 1722** m, Aravalli
  - **Anai Mudi: 2695 m**, South India
  - **Parasnath**: Chotanagpur

- **Parasnath**
  - Highest peak of the **Chotanagpur Plateau**
  - Height **1365 m** (a little higher than Dhupgarh)
  - Location: **Jharkhand, Giridih district**
  - Named after the **23rd Jain Tirthankara**

- **Vindhya** highest peak: **Sadbhavna Shikhar** (Peak of Goodwill), **752 m**

Q27. Through which of the following plateaus does the River Damodar flow?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 09 Jun 2025, Shift 3)

A. Deccan Plateau
B. Chhotanagpur Plateau
C. Malwa Plateau
D. Meghalaya Plateau

- **Damodar** is a **tributary of the Hooghly**
- It flows through the **Chotanagpur Plateau**
- Elimination: Deccan and Malwa lie far west or south; Meghalaya is far east, beyond the Malda Gap

- **Chotanagpur Plateau** is called the **Ruhr of India** (Ruhr state) because it is very **rich in minerals**
  - Covered in detail in the Minerals topic

Q28. Which of the following coastal plains contains irregular, indented coastlines with natural harbours?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26, 18 Jun 2026, 9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)

A. Konkan Region
B. East Coastal Plain
C. Kathiawar Plain
D. Rann of Kutch

- **Western Coastal Plain:** indented (irregular) coastline, so **natural harbours**
  - **Submerging** coast, **narrow** plain
  - A narrow plain keeps the coast close, which suits ports
- **Eastern Coastal Plain: emerging, very wide**
  - Ports have to be **artificial (man-made)**
- Elimination: **Rann of Kutch** and **Kathiawar** are far north; the main western coastal plain runs from **Maharashtra, Goa, Karnataka to Kerala**, so **Konkan** is the pick

COASTS OF INDIA
- **West coast**
  - **Kathiawar Coast**: Gujarat
  - **Konkan Coast:** Maharashtra and Goa (the Konkani language is spoken here)
  - **Kannad (Kanara) Coast**: Karnataka
  - **Malabar Coast**: Kerala
- **East coast**
  - **Coromandel Coast:** Tamil Nadu
  - **Northern Circars:** Andhra Pradesh
  - **Utkal Plains**: Odisha
  - **Banga Coast**: West Bengal (less important)
- Most important to remember: **Malabar** (Kerala) and **Coromandel**

Q29. The Terai belt is best described as:

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26, 17 Jun 2026, 12:45 PM - 2:15 PM)

A. A dry zone made of calcareous deposits
B. A coastal plain formed by marine deposits
C. A marshy tract with a high water table and thick forests
D. A high-altitude snow-covered plain

HOW THESE BELTS FORM
- Rivers from the Himalayas (Indus, Ganga, Brahmaputra and their tributaries) come down from great height at high speed
- They carry **big stones** and deposit them where the slope becomes flat = **Bhabar**
- Order south of the Shiwalik: **Bhabar > Terai > alluvial plains**

- **Terai belt**
  - **Wide belt:** about **15-30 km**
  - **Streams of rivers reappear** here
  - **Marshy and swampy** (dalaldali) area
  - **Thick, dense forests**
  - Fine silt is deposited further on
- Stones stay behind in the Bhabar; water comes forward and reappears in the Terai

Q30. Which feature separates the Malda Gap from the rest of the Ganga-Brahmaputra Plains?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26, 16 Jun 2026, 12:45 PM - 2:15 PM)

A. Meghalaya Plateau
B. Bundelkhand Plateau
C. Rajmahal Hills
D. Aravalli Range

- Peninsular Plateau after the gap
  - **Garo, Khasi, Jaintia = Meghalaya Plateau**
  - **Mikir, Rengma = Karbi Anglong Plateau** (Assam)

- **Rajmahal Hills = easternmost extension** of the Peninsular Plateau
- After them the plateau seems to disappear: this stretch is the **Malda Gap** (also **Malda Fault**)
- Beyond the gap, the **Meghalaya Plateau** appears again
- Elimination: **Aravalli** and **Bundelkhand** have no link; **Meghalaya Plateau** is on the other side of the gap

Q31. Which of the following islands of India is closest to the Malabar Coast?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26, 14 Jun 2026, 12:45 PM - 2:15 PM)

A. Andaman Islands
B. Diu Island
C. Lakshadweep
D. Nicobar Islands

- **Malabar Coast = Kerala**
- **Lakshadweep** is the island group nearest to it

- The **High Court** of Lakshadweep is the **Kerala High Court**

Q32. Which of the following water bodies separates the Andaman Islands from the Nicobar Islands?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26, 07 May 2026, 12:45 PM - 2:15 PM)

A. Palk Strait
B. Nine Degree Channel
C. Ten Degree Channel
D. Duncan Passage

ANDAMAN AND NICOBAR (north to south)
- Andaman: **North Andaman, Middle Andaman, South Andaman, Little Andaman**
- Nicobar: **Car Nicobar, Little Nicobar, Great Nicobar**
- Peaks named in class: **Saddle Peak, Mount Thullier, Mount Diavolo, Mount Koyob**
- **Duncan Passage** is another channel named on the map in this region
- Capital: **Sri Vijayapuram**, in **South Andaman**

- **Ten Degree Channel (10 degrees N)** separates **Andaman** from **Nicobar**
  - It separates **Little Andaman** from **Car Nicobar**
- Other options
  - **Palk Strait:** separates **India** from **Sri Lanka**
  - **Nine Degree Channel:** separates **Lakshadweep** from **Minicoy**

Q33. Which of the following belts of the Northern Plains consists of porous rocky soil where stream water seeps underground?

(NTPC UG CBT-01 2025-26, 07 May 2026, 9:00 AM - 10:30 AM)

A. Delta belt
B. Bhabar belt
C. Terai belt
D. Khadar belt

- Bhabar belt
  - **Narrow belt: 8-16 km** wide
  - Big stones and pebbles deposited by rivers
  - **Porous**, so **streams of rivers disappear** underground
- In the **Terai**, the streams **reappear** (marshy, swampy)

ALLUVIAL PLAINS
- **Khadar**
  - **New alluvium**
  - Lies along the river
  - Gets renewed by fresh deposits (when floods come)
  - **More fertile**; more suitable for agriculture
  - Memory tip: "**khaad**" (manure) = more fertile
- **Bhangar**
  - **Old alluvium**
  - Away from the river banks
- Both have **calcareous (kankar)** concentration, but **more in Bhangar**
- Do not confuse: **Bhabar** is the name of a **belt; Bhangar** is the name of a **soil**

Q34. The total area covered by the Andaman & Nicobar Islands is approximately:

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26, 18 Mar 2026, Shift 3)

A. 6,249 sq. kms
B. 7,567 sq. kms
C. 5,163 sq. kms
D. 8,249 sq. kms

LAKSHADWEEP
- Area: about **32 sq km**
- Largest island: **Androth**
- Smallest island: **Bitra**

- Area of **Andaman and Nicobar Islands: 8,249 sq km**

COASTLINE
- India has **9 coastal states** and **4 coastal Union Territories**
- **Andaman and Nicobar** has the **longest coastline** overall
- Among states, the top three are **Gujarat, Tamil Nadu and Andhra Pradesh** (memory tip: **GTA**)

Q35. Which of the following island groups in India is known to have an active volcano on Barren Island?

(NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2025-26, 16 Mar 2026, Shift 2)

A. Andaman and Nicobar Islands
B. Lakshadweep Islands
C. Minicoy Islands
D. Rameswaram Islands

- **Narcondam**
  - Only **dormant volcano** of India
  - Lies to the **east of North Andaman**
- **Minicoy** is in Lakshadweep (southernmost island)

- **Barren Island** (Andaman and Nicobar)
  - **Only active volcano of India**
  - Lies offshore, east of the main Andaman Islands, in the Andaman Sea.
- Both volcanoes of India are in the **Andaman and Nicobar Islands**

Q36. What is the total number of inhabited islands in the Andaman and Nicobar Islands, as of May 2025?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 02 Sept 2025, Shift 2)

A. Less than 14
B. 22
C. 18
D. More than 30

- **Largest island** of Andaman and Nicobar: **Middle Andaman** (also the largest of the Andaman group)
- **Largest island of Nicobar: Great Nicobar** (southernmost)

- Inhabited islands are roughly **35-36**, so the safe option is **More than 30**
- Reason the examiner avoids an exact number
  - There are **very many islands**
  - Some are very remote and the government has no contact with them, so it is not known whether people live there
  - A specific number such as 22, 18 or 23 would be challenged
  - Exam tip: when the exact figure is uncertain, the **general range** option is usually the answer

Q37. Why is canal irrigation more suitable in the northern plains of India?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 28 Aug 2025, Shift 1)

A. The rivers flow only during monsoon season.
B. The area suffers from very low annual rainfall.
C. The surface is uneven and covered with hills.
D. The flat land and perennial rivers support canal networks

- Northern plains are **flat land**, which is good for laying canals
- **Rivers are perennial**: Ganga, Indus and Brahmaputra do not depend only on the monsoon, because their source is **glaciers** (details in the river system lecture)
- Option C is wrong: plains (maidan) are flat; **mountains and plateaus** are the uneven ones

Q38. Which of the following characteristics is true about the Northern Plains?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 14 Aug 2025, Shift 3)

A. Presence of volcanic plateaus
B. Densely populated due to fertile soil
C. High elevation with steep slopes
D. Low fertility due to rocky terrain

POPULATION DENSITY (state-wise)
- **Bihar**: highest, **1106 per** sq km
- **West Bengal**: second

- Northern plains (**UP, Bihar, West Bengal** and nearby areas) have **fertile alluvial soil** and are **densely populated**
- Other options are wrong
  - No **volcanic plateaus** here
  - No **steep slopes** or **rocky terrain** in UP and Bihar

Q39. Which natural feature divides the Lakshadweep islands into two broad parts?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 14 Aug 2025, Shift 2)

A. Equator
B. Nine Degree Channel
C. Ten Degree Channel
D. Tropic of Cancer

- **Nine Degree Channel (9 degrees N)** separates **Lakshadweep** from **Minicoy**

- Elimination
  - **Equator** passes below India's southern tip
  - **Ten Degree Channel** separates Andaman from Nicobar
  - **Tropic of Cancer** passes through the middle of India

- **Eight Degree Channel**: separates **Minicoy** (and Lakshadweep) from the **Maldives**
- **Eleven Degree Channel**: divides Lakshadweep into two groups
  - Northern group: Amindivi
  - Southern group: **Cannanore** (Kannur)
  - If 11 degrees were an option in place of 9 degrees, it would also be right

Q40. Which of the following belongs to the Lakshadweep group of islands?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 13 Aug 2025, Shift 1)

A. Kannur Islands
B. Kamorta Island
C. Chowra Island
D. Milo Island

- **Kannur (Cannanore)** Islands belong to **Lakshadweep**
- **Kamorta** and **Chowra** belong to **Andaman and Nicobar**

Q41. What is the main reason behind the formation of lagoons along the Eastern Coastal Plains?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 08 Aug 2025, Shift 2)

A. Sand deposition along the shallow coastlines
B. Tectonic activity and fault line shifts
C. Coral reef development and volcanic islands
D. Deposition by rivers and wave action along the coast

WEST COAST vs EAST COAST
- **West coast**: submerging; **erosional** features; rivers form **estuaries**; indented coastline
- **East coast**: emerging; wide; **depositional** features; **deltas**

- The **Peninsular Plateau is tilted towards the east**, so most rivers flow east
- On the **east coast**, rivers **deposit sediment** and form **deltas**; waves add to the deposition

- Elimination: **coral reefs** cannot form here
  - Corals live only in **clear, saline (salty) water**, not in fresh or muddy river water
  - Coral polyps contain **algae (zooxanthellae)** that need sunlight for photosynthesis
  - Many rivers fall here, so water is fresh and muddy

Q42. Which of the following Indian states has all three types of physical divisions – plateau, plains, and coastal plains?

(RRB NTPC UG CBT-01 2024, 08 Aug 2025, Shift 1)

A. Madhya Pradesh
B. Tamil Nadu
C. Punjab
D. Uttar Pradesh

- Exam tip: pick the **coastal plain** clue first and the question ends

- A state needs a **coast** to have a **coastal plain**
- **Madhya Pradesh** is **landlocked**
- **Punjab** and **Uttar Pradesh** are far from the sea, so they have no coastal plain
- India has **9 coastal states; Tamil Nadu** is one of them and has all three divisions

Q43. Which of the following is NOT located in the Andaman group?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 16 Jun 2025, Shift 1)

A. Havelock
B. Minicoy
C. Neil
D. Barren

- **Havelock, Neil, Barren** are in the **Andaman group**
- **Minicoy** is in **Lakshadweep**, at its **southernmost** part

Q44. The total length of the Northern Plain of India from west to east is approximately _____.

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 14 Jun 2025, Shift 2)

A. 3500 km
B. 3200 km
C. 1600 km
D. 2400 km

- Northern Plain stretches from **Punjab** to the **North-East** (Assam)
- Length **in India: 2400 km**
- Length of the **whole plain: 3200 km**, because it also extends into **Pakistan** and **Bangladesh**
- The question says "of India", so the answer is **2400 km**

Q45. The Great Plains of India were primarily formed due to the deposition by which of the following rivers?

(RRB NTPC Graduation CBT-01 2024, 14 Jun 2025, Shift 2)

A. Indus, Ganga and Brahmaputra
B. Narmada, Tapi and Mahanadi
C. Krishna, Godavari and Kaveri
D. Yamuna, Sutlej and Gomti

- The Northern Plain is made by the **interplay of three rivers**
- West to east
  - **Indus**: western part
  - **Ganga**: middle part
  - **Brahmaputra**: eastern part



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